

# OREGON STATE HOSPITAL

## POLICY

**SECTION 6:** Patient Care **POLICY: 6.070**

**SUBJECT:** Provision of Medical Care of Patients

**POINT PERSON:** Chief of Medicine

**APPROVED:** James Diegel

**DATE:** JULY 8, 2025

  
James Diegel  
Interim Superintendent

7/8/2025

Interim Superintendent

**SELECT ONE:** ☒ New policy

☐ Minor/technical revision of existing policy

☐ Reaffirmation of existing policy

☐ Major revision of existing policy

### I. PURPOSE

- A. Oregon State Hospital (OSH) will provide, or ensure the provision of, appropriate medical treatment or consultation for its patients 24 hours per day.
- B. The provision of care includes a History and Physical Examination within twenty-four hours after inpatient admission.
- C. Medical staff will provide for appraisal of emergencies, initial treatment, and referral when appropriate.
- D. The Chief of Medicine or designee is informed of all movement between OSH and medical hospitals for continuity of medical care and treatment.

### II. GUIDELINES

- A. OSH Medical Care

1. At OSH-Salem and OSH-Junction City, from 8:30 a.m. to 4:30 p.m., Monday through Friday, the Medical Clinic physicians and nurse practitioners are available to assist in the treatment of patients.
2. Medical Providers who are assigned to specific units are responsible for rounding on their assigned units each day and attending at least one morning report each working day: they will apportion their week so that morning report attendance is divided as equally as possible between their assigned units.
3. Medical Providers who are assigned to cross cover units will physically round for an absent colleague on 3 or fewer units. If assigned four or more units, cross coverage is provided by phone triage to the clinic.
4. On weekends or holidays the MOD will be onsite for a minimum of 4 hours per each 24-hour period. MOD will contact each unit to triage patient needs with unit RN and will round on Butterfly units and others as needed.
5. During weekday daily rounds the Medical Provider will consult with Nursing Staff to determine which patients are to be seen and will document as per Medical Clinic Provider Documentation Standards protocol 1.017.
6. Urgent interventions requested by the Medical Provider will be relayed to Nursing Staff in person or by phone and then documented in the progress note.
7. Unit Staff will notify the Medical Provider assigned to that unit as a primary or cross-covering provider of any medical problems during normal business hours (Monday through Friday from 0800 to 1630). Outside of these times, or if the Medical Provider is unable to respond in a timely manner, the unit Psychiatrist or Psychiatric Nurse Practitioner will be notified, who will then coordinate with the Medical Provider or the Medical Clinic for appropriate follow-up care.
8. As outlined in the Medical Department Protocol 1.011, "On-Duty Physician", staff should contact the POD for medical emergencies when the Medical Clinic is closed. The POD shall assess the situation and may refer the call to the MOD. The MOD shall also be available for telephone consultation with OSH-Junction City POD.
9. If medical services are required during an Admission, an overhead page will call for the Physician on Duty: the POD and the MOD for that day will respond to the Admissions area and will request additional medical assistance as indicated.

10. Medical care is provided on the unit whenever possible. Specialty clinics, procedures and some special or sensitive exams (such as pelvic exams) are done in the medical clinic as ordered by the medical provider.

#### B. Outside Medical Care

1. Non-emergent movement to medical hospitals must be accompanied by the following information:
  - a. a photocopy or printout of the current face sheet;
  - b. the most recent medical review;
  - c. recent pertinent laboratory work;
  - d. completed hospital transfer forms filled out by the physician and nurse;
  - e. completed billing authorization form;
  - f. a case summary updated to include the most recent problems and treatment or recent progress notes;
  - g. copies of medical and psychiatric Advance Directives and the Physician Orders for Life-Sustaining Treatment (POLST) form.
2. All referrals of OSH patients to an outside medical hospital must be accompanied by a fax to a triage nurse for Salem Hospital (specific form from Salem Hospital) a phone call to River Bend from the OSH physician, psychiatric mental health nurse practitioner, medical clinic physician or POD. Communication must include pertinent medical and psychiatric information, the name and phone number of the unit physician, and the patient's unit.
3. Telephone contact between the treating provider from the medical hospital and the receiving OSH clinic provider needs to occur prior to the patient's return to OSH.
4. Use of restraints during must follow OSH Policy 8.039, "Use of Restraints for Emergency Medical Transfers and Medical Appointments."

#### C. Continuity of Care

1. All patients returning from an outside hospital or Emergency Department must be seen face-to-face by their attending psychiatrist or psychiatric mental health nurse practitioner (or POD) or medical provider within eight hours after return to OSH.
2. Nursing must notify the psychiatrist or psychiatric mental health nurse practitioner (or POD) and medical provider (MOD) of the patient's return.

### **III. DEFINITIONS**

- A. "Psychiatrist On Duty (POD)" means the psychiatrist assigned to provide campus-wide coverage outside of normal business hours.
- B. "Psychiatrist On Duty (POD)" means the psychiatrist assigned to provide campus-wide coverage outside of normal business hours.

### **IV. RELATED OSH POLICIES AND PROTOCOLS**

#### **A. POLICY**

8.038 Code Blue Medical Emergency

#### **B. PROTOCOLS**

- i. 8.001 Protocol Admission, Annual and Discharge Physical Exams and Laboratory Evaluations